

The Forgotten Mile

August 2, 2020

Each year I return to the Forgotten Mile, and each year the Forgotten Mile sees a new me.

It saw an eight week old first dip his toes into that stretch of the Atlantic.

It saw a two year old stutter, and his parents cry.

It saw a boy learn to love the shore and the smell of the salt air.

It saw castles rise, holes dug, waves ridden.

It saw the boy grow up around family, learning to love from their example.

It saw the family weep, for they had lost the King who brought them to the shore.

It also saw them heal, relying on their love for one another.

It saw the boy mature, and learn to face the challenges of growing up.

With growing came sadness, heartache, loss

and the shore saw that too.

As time drew on, it saw a Rose taken from the family.

Although this Rose was taken, she left behind a legacy of unconditional love.

It saw the boy in his darkest moments, unwavering in its resolution.

It saw the boy sail through these times, learning how to love with humility and grace.

The Forgotten Mile now sees the boy looking out on the shore,

wondering what it will see in the coming years.

It sees Hummingbirds fluttering on Dodd Avenue, a reminder of those who gave the family the gift of the shore.

We have grown, experienced great joy and great sorrow:

The Forgotten Mile has watched silently on, remaining as consistent as the tides that wash over her shores.